

authentication making it more secure. But it has its own tradeoffs too. Your Microsoft account connects your computer to your account and starts storing a lot of personal data which you might not be comfortable with.

So don't create a Microsoft Account when you are prompted to do so and instead select "local account" instead. If you have already made and are using one, follow these steps to disconnect your machine from it:

- Open Start Menu and Type 'Account', then select 'Manage your account'
- Click on 'Sign in with a local account instead'
- Create a new username and a secure password
- Log out and log in again using the new account.
- Again go to the 'Manage your account' setting and remove your older account from under the 'Other accounts you use' tab.

You will lose out on some features including Cortana if you use a local account but that is the price you pay for securing your privacy and data on a Windows machine.

• Stay away from Cortana

Cortana is one of the most talked about feature of Windows 10 and one step towards a future where everyone will have their own J.A.R.V.I.S. Cortana gathers information and learns about you from your location, contacts, speech data and much more, to create a more personalised experience for you. But to do this, it access loads of personal and sensitive information some of which you may not be comfortable sharing with Microsoft. If you want to disable Cortana, Go to 'Privacy' settings, Select "Speech, inking and typing" from the left menu and change the setting to "Stop getting to know me" and you are done.

If you have had Cortana enabled for a while, you would also want to delete all the information it has stored already. To view and delete it, go to <https://www.bing.com/account/personalization>. Once logged in, clear all data including "interests" and "Speech, Inking and Typing" information. **d**